being caught behind off the excellent Ryan Harris. Faf, JP and Vernon all made the Australians sweat for their wickets and, with only five overs left and two wickets still standing, we seemed set to secure the draw.

Clarke was concerned and threw the ball to Harris, who immediately obliged with a perfect yorker to end Dale's brave resistance. When he clean bowled Morné two balls later, Australia had won.

We then lost two T20 internationals against the tourists, and both teams travelled to compete in another edition of the now biennial ICC World Twenty20 tournament, being hosted in Bangladesh.

Our strategy was to direct all our energy towards getting the basics right, resisting the temptation to try anything too smart, but in our opening match against Sri Lanka we fielded poorly and then lost our way in what should have been a reasonable run chase, losing wickets regularly and eventually finishing five runs short.

The margins were small, and we won our next match against New Zealand when Dale bowled a magnificent last over. The Black Caps had needed only seven runs to win, but he held his nerve, bowled fast and accurately and ensured we squeaked to a two-run win. As one writer commented, we had produced an 'anti-choke'.

After beating the Netherlands, we faced England in what amounted to a quarterfinal. Faf had been banned from the match following another technical over-rate violation, so I captained the team and managed to score 69 not out in 28 balls as we reached 196 for five in 20 overs, a competitive total. The English chased hard but we bowled and fielded well, and deserved to win and advance to a semifinal against India.

The pre-match stats were not encouraging: it had been 14 years (five Champions Trophies, five World Cups and three World T20s) since we last won a knockout match at an ICC event, and India had never lost a semifinal in any tournament under the calm and collected captaincy of MS Dhoni.

We batted first and made 174 for four, which seemed a par total in